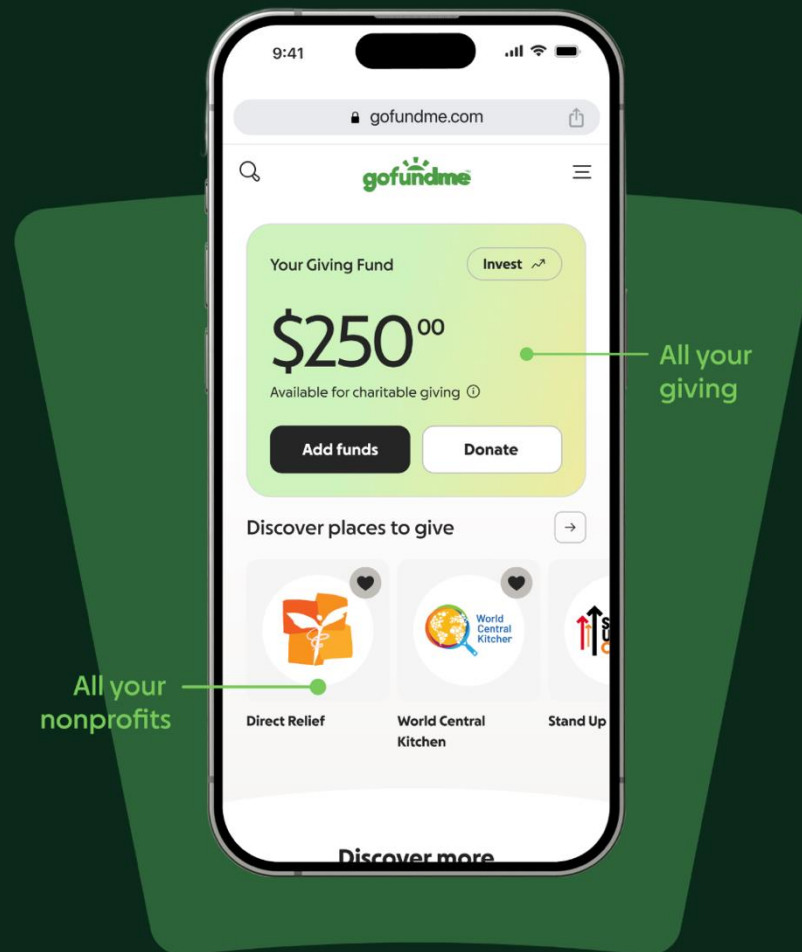




'Giving Funds': A top-of-funnel POV in the GTM

GoFundMe's donor-advised fund (DAF) is a new product for the mass-market and there is room to improve how it is positioned and discovered. This deck explores **opportunities to strengthen awareness and acquisition.**



The opportunity

Giving Funds launched mid-2025 as GoFundMe's donor-advised fund (DAF): **no fees, no minimums, give from as little as \$5.**

It's built for the **mass market** — bringing DAFs to everyday people and actively encouraging them to give.

The category is booming (DAF assets have **nearly doubled since 2020**), yet DAFs still read as “for the wealthy”. Most people in the mass-market have no idea what a DAF is.

The job: make an unfamiliar product feel simple, familiar, and accessible.



THE REAL DIFFERENTIATOR

It isn't \$0 fees — it's **distribution**. A fundraising platform that has 200M+ existing user. Rivals must buy that audience.

GoFundMe already owns it.

Where it sits in the market

Provider	Cohort	Fees	Minimum donation	Built for
GoFundMe ‘Giving Funds’	New-age	\$0	\$5	Everyday mass-market donors , small ticket size
Daffy	New-age	\$3/mo or \$36/yr	\$18	Mass-market donors
Charityvest	New-age	\$0	\$15	Mass-market & B2B donors
Fidelity · DAFGiving360 (Schwab) · Vanguard	Traditional	~0.6% of assets / yr or \$100-\$250/yr	\$50 - \$500	High-net-worth households
NPT · Goldman Sachs PF · community foundations	Traditional	Asset-based	\$10000 - \$25000	HNW & institutional

*New-age DAFs compete on price and user experience. GoFundMe **lowers the minimum donation amount, lowering the barrier to entry for users** – and beats everyone on reach.*

Primary customer segments

Same setup for everyone: pick a source (*cash, card, stock/ETF, DAF transfer, private shares (upcoming) & crypto (upcoming)*) → choose non-profits → set contribution goals (if needed) → one-time or recurring (*recurring preferred*). The real goal is getting them to **start and invest**.



THE SOCIAL GIVER

Marcus, 31 · salaried, donates when he sees a cause/person he supports

Comes to GoFundMe to back a friend's campaign and notices 'Giving Funds'. Has never used a DAF — no mental model for one.

"Keep a little set aside, so you're always ready to help someone you care about. Start with \$5."

WHY THEY'D DROP OFF

Doesn't grasp what a DAF is, or why not just donate directly. The page/app doesn't make it clear immediately, so he bounces. All he cares about is helping when it's required via people/platforms he trusts.

HOW WE WIN THEM

- 1) Add a 30–60 second explainer video on the main page that answers these questions: (i) What is a DAF? (ii) How is Giving fund different? (iii) Why use it instead of donating directly via GoFundMe?
- 2) Hit the post-donation confirmation screen + email with "You just backed Sara. Want to set aside \$20/month so you're ready next time?"
- 3) Retarget people who've donated 2+ times in 6 months (proven repeat behavior)



ORGANIZED GIVER

Elena, 41 · gives regularly throughout the year, wants it organized

Donates throughout the year across multiple nonprofits and fundraisers. Wants a simpler way to track her giving and plan charitable contributions to causes she supports.

"All your giving, organized. One growing charitable wallet, one year-end receipt, no more digging through your inbox."

WHY THEY'D DROP OFF

Trust gap — GoFundMe is known for crowdfunding causes, not holding & investing money. "Give now, grant later, irrevocable" gives her pause.

HOW WE WIN THEM

- 1) Reframe irrevocable as a feature - "You always choose the charity and the timing; the only thing locked in is that it stays committed to good."
- 2) Include testimonials from other existing donors on the landing page
- 3) Establish trust by explaining the 501 (c) (3) structure and also the ETF/fund managers on the funding screen
- 4) Reach her in-product through her own giving history ("you gave to 7 nonprofits across 14 gifts this year - manage it in one place"), and at tax season in January when the receipt pain is acute (especially if she's an itemizer). Nonprofits she already supports become a referral channel.

Other customer segments

Same setup for everyone: pick a source (*cash, card, stock/ETF, DAF transfer, private shares (upcoming) & crypto (upcoming)*) → choose non-profits → set contribution goals (if needed) → one-time or recurring (*recurring preferred*). The real goal is getting them to **start and invest**.

Event-driven segment: DAF consideration spikes during tax season, stock vesting, and other liquidity events



THE WINDFALL RECIPIENT

Priya, 37 · tech professional, received RSUs/bonus

Had a high-income year and is looking for ways to reduce taxes while supporting causes she cares about. Doesn't necessarily have a long-term giving strategy.

"Big income year? Lock in the deduction now, then give it out for years to come."

WHY THEY'D DROP OFF

Doesn't understand how a Giving Fund creates tax benefits for her, or why contributing now and donating later is better than making direct donations.

HOW WE WIN THEM

- 1) Hit vesting cycles and year-end (Oct–Dec) for email and social media campaigns
- 2) Focus on the advantages of donating appreciated stock and its impact on reducing capital gains tax - show it with a calculator: input RSU value → show deduction + cap-gains avoided
- 3) Reach tech-related personal-finance creators, newsletters, and podcasts
- 4) Paid search on high-intent queries like "reduce taxes on RSU vesting."

Potential future customer with growth and expansion into the market



ADVANCED PHILANTHROPIST

David, 58 · high net worth, runs a DAF

Sophisticated, tax-savvy giver who already bunches and donates appreciated assets. Not shopping for a new DAF as his current one works fine. Here out of curiosity, not intent.

"Use GoFundMe for the giving your DAF can't do - discovering real causes and giving the moment it matters."

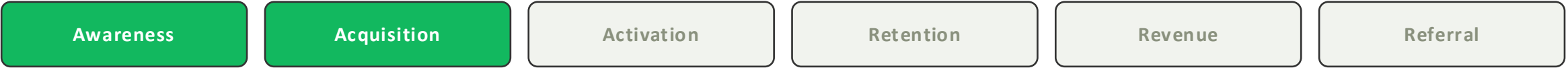
WHY THEY'D DROP OFF

Depth gap — GoFundMe is newer, with fewer investment options, no complex-asset support (private shares/crypto) yet, and a shorter institutional track record.

HOW WE WIN THEM

- 1) HNW peer word of mouth (takes time to build trust)
- 2) Ask him to open a small Giving Fund for responsive/emotional giving (disaster relief, community causes to verified non-profits) while keeping his main DAF where it is. Don't force him to switch DAFs immediately.
- 3) Capture interest now with a transparent roadmap waitlist (private shares, crypto, advisor access) so he converts more fully as depth arrives

How we'll know it's working



The personas above are **awareness and acquisition strategies**. Beyond that, we need data to make any inferences — we read the drop-off between funnel stages to find where people churn, then fix that stage.

Stage	Metrics to track	A drop here may tell us
Awareness	Page views, walkthrough/video completion rate	Users are seeing Giving Funds but the positioning isn't resonating
Acquisition	CTR on "Start a Giving Fund/ Get Started", onboarding completion rate, Giving Fund accounts created	Users understand the product but aren't convinced enough to start or finish onboarding
Activation	% of accounts funded, time to first contribution, average first contribution amount	Users created an account but don't trust the product enough to move money into it
Retention	Repeat contributions, recurring contribution setup rate	Giving Funds isn't becoming part of the user's giving habit
Revenue	Total tips, total payment processing fees, Assets Under Management (AUM), average account balance	<i>(Note: Given the product's zero-fee structure, it is unclear whether Giving Funds is intended to be a direct revenue generator. This analysis assumes its primary value lies in increasing donor engagement, retention, and charitable assets within the GoFundMe ecosystem)</i>
Referral	% of new Giving Fund accounts created through referral links, nonprofit referrals, or partner referrals	Users aren't finding enough value to recommend the product